

Earthy = Marsy

Earthy = Venusy

But, for reasons we have already discussed — namely, the fact that identity is transitive — these three claims do not sit well together. So it appears that the psychological theory implies a contradiction.

Marsy $\neq$ Venusy



Basically the same point could be made about the version of the story on which, after the transmission to Mars, the individual who steps into the teletransporter on Earth steps back out. To tell that version of the story, we'd just need to introduce two names — Earthy-1 and Earthy-2 — for the individual on earth pre-teletransportation, and the individual who exists after the teletransportation.

It is easy enough to turn this into an argument against the psychological theory of survival.

1. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Earthy = Marsy.
 2. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Earthy = Venusy.
 3. If the psychological theory of survival is true, then Marsy = Venusy. (1,2)
 4. Marsy $\neq$ Venusy.
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C. The psychological theory of survival is false.
(3,4)

We now have three ‘pure’ views of personal identity on the table, along with the various combinations of those views.

THE TELETRANSPORTATION ARGUMENT

Why are these puzzling from the point of view of theories of survival?

Our topic today is a cluster of puzzles about identity and survival. These puzzles put pressure, in different ways, on some of true assumptions about survival we have been making so far.

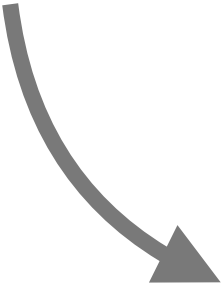
One good way to test out your preferred view of survival is to think about what your view implies with respect to these three puzzles.

Now think about a case in which a split-brain patient has a red stimulus presented to the right half of their visual field, and a blue stimulus presented to the left half of their visual field. If you ask the subject what color they see, they will say “Red”, since this was the color presented to the part of the eye which feeds input to the left hemisphere of the brain, which controls speech. If you ask the person to pick out with their left hand an object of the same color as the one they saw, they will pick out a blue object.

In this example, there is
a reddish conscious
experience and a bluish
conscious experience.

For every experience,
there is a person who is
having the experience.

There is a person having a
reddish experience and a
person having a bluish
experience.





If a person has a
conscious reddish (or
bluish) experience, it
must be possible for them
to be aware of that
experience.

In this example, the individual having the reddish experience $\neq$ the person having the bluish experience.





But it also seems plausible
that if someone is having a
conscious experience of a
color, they can be aware of
that experience.

It is not possible for the person having the reddish experience to be aware of the bluish experience (or vice versa).



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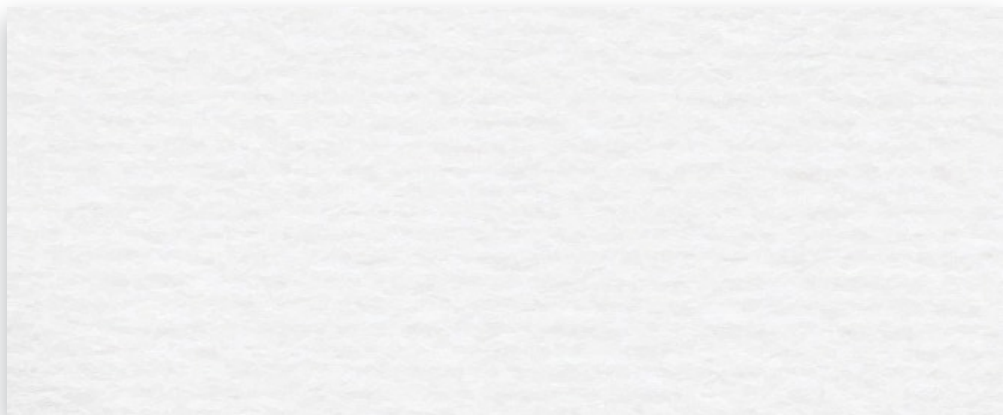
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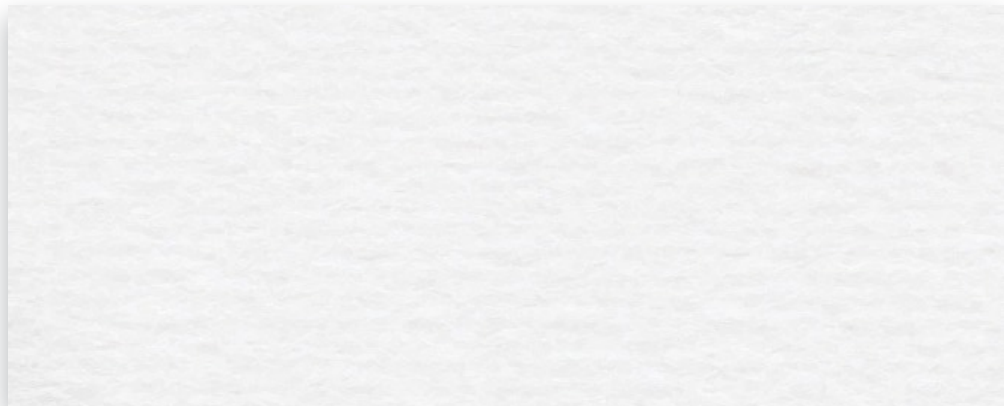
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